

Land & Traffic Committee Meeting July 23rd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GvInMrx3aMg
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Land and Traffic Committee Meeting Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Land and Traffic Committee Work Session focusing on municipal code enforcement jurisdictions, parking violations, property maintenance, and inter-agency coordination 00:00:30.
- **Summary of Discussion:** Committee members and neighborhood residents raised recurring concerns regarding persistent parking violations (vehicles, boats, trailers parked in front yards), abandoned vehicles, uncut grass, trash/debris accumulation, and hoarding properties. Representatives from the Building Commissioner's Office, Police Department, and Sanitary District clarified jurisdictional boundaries, reporting procedures, timelines for citations, and remediation processes. The group discussed creating an updated "Who to Call" directory pamphlet to improve public communication and reduce misdirected complaints.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The Land and Traffic Committee meeting was called to order by the presiding committee chair 00:00:30.
- **Attendance:**

- **Present (Speaking / Identified):** Committee Chair, Mr. Privet (Resident), Richard Rawlings (Building Commissioner), Chief Sloan (Police Department), Officer Darren Clark (Police Department Code Enforcement), Jason Detti (Superintendent of Sanitation and Recycling), Candace PBA (Resident).
- **Absent:** Roll call was conducted via audio, but specific full roster absences were not explicitly itemized in the transcript.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding chair 00:00:34.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed or acted upon.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(Note: The meeting was structured as an informational work session and committee inquiry regarding code enforcement rather than formal legislative voting on ordinances.)

- **00:01:37 Discussion: Parking Violations and Front-Yard Parking**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Privet (Resident) / Richard Rawlings & Officer Darren Clark.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Residents expressed frustration over prolonged illegal front-yard parking (boats, commercial trailers, unmovable vehicles parked on grass/dirt rather than permitted gravel or side/rear yards). Officials clarified that front-yard parking enforcement falls under the Police Department's parking division (Chapter 77) or Building Commission depending on the infraction. Residents were encouraged to submit time- and date-stamped photos to assist officers, since code staff work standard daytime hours (8:00 AM <U+2013> 4:00 PM) while many violating vehicles are away during the day.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Mr. Privet and Candace PBA presented specific neighborhood concerns regarding abandoned trailers, unkempt yards, and potential fire hazards.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:18:02 Discussion: Property Maintenance, Trash, Debris, and High Grass**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Richard Rawlings (Building Commissioner) & Jason Detti (Sanitation Superintendent).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Outlined the division of labor between the Building Commission (trash, debris, unsafe structures, grass over 12 inches) and the Sanitary District (toter placement, bulk trash, illegal dumping). Rawlings explained the citation process: a 10-day notice/tag, followed by fines/court referral for debris, or municipal mowing billed to property taxes (\$100 admin fee plus hourly mowing fees,

averaging ~\$300) for unkempt grass. Officials noted high workloads, particularly seasonal student move-outs around Ball State University.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion only; no formal vote taken.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:02:55 Richard Rawlings (Building Commissioner):** Provided initial testimony on gravel parking standards and building code enforcement hours.
- **00:07:16 Chief Sloan & Officer Darren Clark (Police Department):** Clarified police-side code enforcement, state statutes regarding abandoned vehicles (IC 9-13-2-1), and parking division contact channels.
- **00:22:29 Candace PBA (Resident):** Raised concerns regarding neighborhood hoarding properties, blocked front doors creating fire hazards, and overflowing yards.
- **00:25:15 Jason Detti (Sanitation Superintendent):** Explained sanitation codes, Peterson grapple truck schedules, bulk waste rules, and container placement regulations.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Committee members and department heads agreed on the need to collaborate on a streamlined "Who to Call" resource guide and pamphlet to be published on city and department websites and distributed locally.
- **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made and seconded **00:43:28**. The meeting concluded with voice agreement.

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